Can You Make Money on TikTok? 10 Real Ways to Start Earning

10 Real Ways · Start Earning · 2026 | Updated October 28, 2026

Can you make money on TikTok? Yes, there are several ways creators and businesses can use TikTok to generate income. Some methods involve TikTok's own monetization features, while others use TikTok to find customers, promote products, work with brands, or build an audience for another business.

You don't necessarily need millions of followers to start exploring these opportunities. A smaller audience in a specific niche can sometimes be more useful than a large audience with little interest in what you offer.

If you're wondering **how to make money on TikTok**, the first step is understanding the different ways creators can turn videos, followers, and attention into income.

Below are 10 practical methods to consider.

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1. Earn Through the TikTok Creator Rewards Program

The Creator Rewards Program is one of TikTok's direct monetization options in eligible markets.

The program is designed to reward eligible creators for qualifying original content under

TikTok's current rules. Availability and requirements can vary by country and can change over time.

If you're interested in this option, check your TikTok Studio or creator monetization area for the latest information available to your account.

Generally, creators need to:

* Build an eligible account
* Publish original content
* Follow TikTok's policies
* Meet the current program requirements
* Apply if the program is available in their region

Don't assume that every view automatically produces earnings. TikTok's monetization programs have their own rules about eligible or qualified views.

2. Make Money From Brand Deals

Brand sponsorships are one of the most common ways creators monetize an established TikTok audience.

A company may pay you to feature its product, demonstrate a service, create a review, or produce a sponsored video.

For example, a creator in the gaming niche could work with:

* Gaming accessory brands
* Gaming software companies
* Mobile apps

* Headset manufacturers
* Gaming services

A beauty creator might work with skincare or makeup brands.

The opportunity depends on factors such as audience relevance, engagement, content quality, niche, and campaign requirements.

You don't always need millions of followers

A niche account with a few thousand highly relevant followers may have commercial value.

For brands, the question isn't always:

"How many people follow this creator?"

It can also be:

"Are the right people watching this creator?"

3. Use Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing allows you to recommend products and potentially earn a commission when viewers make qualifying purchases.

For example, you could create a video such as:

"5 budget microphones for TikTok creators."

You can explain what each microphone does, show it in use, and provide an appropriate affiliate shopping option where available.

Popular affiliate niches include:

* Technology
* Gaming
* Beauty
* Fashion
* Fitness
* Home products
* Travel
* Education
* Cooking

The most important part is relevance.

If your account is about fitness, promoting unrelated products simply because they have a commission can make your content feel less trustworthy.

4. Sell Your Own Products

TikTok can be used to promote products you own or sell.

These can include physical products such as:

* Clothing
* Accessories
* Artwork
* Handmade products

* Beauty products
* Collectibles

You can create videos demonstrating the products instead of simply posting advertisements.

For example, if you sell handmade jewelry, show how a piece is made, how it looks when worn, or how you package an order.

Behind-the-scenes videos can make promotional content more interesting.

5. Sell Digital Products

Digital products can be another way to make money from TikTok without managing physical inventory.

Potential products include:

* Ebooks
* Templates
* Printable planners
* Study guides
* Checklists
* Design resources
* Presets
* Educational materials
* Courses

Imagine you have a TikTok account about studying.

You could create short videos showing study techniques and offer a downloadable study planner or revision template.

Your free content attracts an audience, while the digital product gives interested viewers something more detailed.

6. Offer Services Through TikTok

If you have a professional skill, TikTok can act as a public portfolio.

You can use short videos to demonstrate your expertise and attract potential clients.

Services could include:

* SEO
* Web design
* Graphic design
* Video editing
* Copywriting
* Photography
* Social media management
* Tutoring
* Consulting
* Programming

For example, a graphic designer could create a video showing how they redesigned a business logo.

A video editor could show a before-and-after editing example.

A website developer could explain three common website mistakes.

The video itself doesn't have to generate direct TikTok revenue. It can generate a client lead instead.

7. Make Money With TikTok LIVE

LIVE content gives creators another way to interact with viewers.

Eligible accounts may have access to LIVE monetization features, including virtual gifts and other tools depending on their region.

Creators can use LIVE sessions for:

* Gaming
* Q&A
* Tutorials
* Music
* Interviews
* Product demonstrations
* Educational sessions
* Discussions

The key is to give viewers a reason to stay.

Instead of simply going LIVE without a plan, choose a topic.

For example:

"LIVE: I'll answer your TikTok growth questions."

A clear topic makes it easier for interested followers to decide whether they want to join.

8. Create UGC for Companies

You don't have to become a traditional influencer to make money with TikTok-style content.

Businesses sometimes need creators who can produce user-generated-content videos for advertising and social media.

UGC can include:

* Product demonstrations
* Unboxing videos
* Testimonials
* Tutorials
* Lifestyle clips
* Product comparisons
* Short promotional videos

The company may be interested in your ability to create convincing videos rather than the size of your personal audience.

This makes UGC an option for people who enjoy filming and editing but don't want to depend entirely on follower growth.

9. Use TikTok to Generate Business Leads

Another answer to **can you make money on TikTok** is to use the platform to find customers.

Suppose you own a business providing:

* Home services
* Marketing
* Coaching
* Photography
* Consulting
* Fitness training
* Education
* Design

You can create educational TikTok videos around your area of expertise.

A person who discovers your video may later become a customer.

For example, a local photographer could post:

"3 things to know before booking a wedding photographer."

Someone planning a wedding may discover the video and visit the photographer's profile.

The TikTok view becomes a potential business lead.

10. Build an Audience and Monetize It in Multiple Ways

Instead of relying on one income source, you can build a broader monetization system.

For example:

TikTok videos → followers → email list → digital products → affiliate offers

Or:

TikTok videos → followers → brand deals → sponsored content

Or:

TikTok videos → audience → website → products and services

This approach can make your TikTok presence more valuable over time.

How to Make Money on TikTok as a Beginner

If you are starting from zero, don't worry about trying all 10 methods at once.

Start with three basic steps.

Step 1: Pick a topic

Choose a subject you understand or genuinely enjoy.

Examples include:

* Gaming
* Fitness
* Technology
* Cooking
* Education

* Beauty
* Finance
* Travel
* Productivity
* Entertainment

Step 2: Create useful videos

Your first objective should be attracting the right audience.

Answer questions, demonstrate things, share tips, explain concepts, or entertain viewers.

Step 3: Choose a monetization method

Once you understand what your audience wants, choose an income method that fits.

For example:

TikTok niche | **Potential monetization**

Gaming | Affiliate products, sponsorships, UGC
Fitness | Coaching, products, sponsorships
Technology | Affiliate marketing, sponsorships
Education | Courses, tutoring, digital products
Beauty | Brand deals, affiliate marketing
Cooking | Products, sponsorships, affiliate offers
Business | Consulting, services, digital products

How Do You Make Money on TikTok From Views?

Views can help create income opportunities, but views themselves don't always equal money.

If you're eligible for a TikTok monetization program, qualifying views may contribute to rewards according to that program's rules.

Outside direct creator payments, views can also create opportunities for:

* Affiliate sales
* Sponsorships
* Product purchases
* Website traffic
* Customer inquiries
* Service bookings

For example, 100,000 views on a tutorial could send people to your website.

Another 100,000 views on a product demonstration could generate affiliate clicks.

The value of a view depends partly on what happens after someone watches the video.

How to Get Monetized on TikTok

If you're specifically searching for **how to get monetized on TikTok**, start by checking which monetization features are currently available to your account.

TikTok's requirements vary by program and location.

A basic process is:

1. Create an account around a consistent topic.
2. Publish original videos.
3. Build genuine engagement.
4. Follow TikTok's rules.
5. Open TikTok Studio or the relevant creator tools.
6. Review available monetization programs.
7. Check the current eligibility requirements.
8. Apply when your account qualifies.

Don't rely on old screenshots or outdated articles for requirements because TikTok can change program rules.

Can You Make Money on TikTok Without 10,000 Followers?

The answer depends on the monetization method.

You may not need a large following to:

* Sell services
* Create UGC
* Promote your own products
* Use affiliate marketing
* Generate business leads

Some direct TikTok monetization programs can have specific follower, view, age, location, or account requirements.

That's why it's useful to separate **TikTok paying you directly** from **using TikTok to generate income elsewhere**.

How Much Can You Make on TikTok?

There is no universal TikTok salary or guaranteed payment amount.

Your income can depend on:

* Audience size
* Qualified views
* Engagement
* Niche
* Audience location
* Brand deals
* Affiliate conversions
* Product sales
* Service prices
* LIVE activity
* Available TikTok monetization programs

Two accounts with the same number of followers can therefore make very different amounts.

One may have a highly commercial audience while another may primarily attract viewers who watch for entertainment.

TikTok Creator Fund vs Creator Rewards Program

Many people searching for TikTok monetization still use the term **TikTok Creator Fund**.

The Creator Fund was an earlier creator payment program. TikTok has introduced the **Creator Rewards Program** in eligible markets as a newer monetization option.

If you're trying to determine which program applies to you, check the current information in your TikTok account.

Program availability, requirements, and features can vary by location.

Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines

Creators searching for the **Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines** should check their own TikTok Studio for the latest availability and eligibility information.

TikTok monetization features are not necessarily identical in every country.

Instead of relying on a general follower or view threshold found in an old article, verify the current requirements shown by TikTok for your account.

How to Make Money From TikTok Without Showing Your Face

You can create a TikTok account without making your face the main focus of every video.

Some examples include:

Screen recordings

Useful for:

* App tutorials
* Software guides
* Gaming
* Website tutorials

Voice-over videos

You can explain a topic while showing relevant footage or graphics.

Hands-only videos

Useful for:

* Cooking
* Crafts
* Drawing
* Product demonstrations

Text-based videos

You can combine text, graphics, animations, and original footage.

However, faceless content should still provide genuine value and follow TikTok's rules.

How to Make Money Off TikTok Videos

If your goal is specifically to monetize videos, think beyond direct creator payments.

A single video can potentially:

* Attract followers
* Promote an affiliate product
* Introduce your service
* Generate a customer
* Promote your own product

* Attract a brand
* Send traffic to your website

This is why a creator should think about the purpose of each video.

Not every post needs to sell something, but your overall content strategy should have a clear direction.

7 Tips to Increase Your TikTok Income Opportunities

1. Choose a clear niche

A focused account makes it easier to build a relevant audience.

2. Solve specific problems

Educational and problem-solving content can give viewers a reason to follow you.

3. Create strong hooks

Tell viewers what they'll learn or see early in the video.

4. Track your analytics

Look at watch time, engagement, shares, comments, and profile visits.

5. Don't buy fake engagement

Fake followers and views can damage the quality of your audience and may violate platform rules.

6. Build trust

Only recommend products and services that make sense for your audience.

7. Diversify your income

Don't depend entirely on one program or one brand.

Common TikTok Monetization Mistakes

Many beginners focus only on follower count.

Other mistakes include:

* Posting copied videos
* Buying followers
* Buying views
* Promoting unrelated products
* Making unrealistic earning claims
* Posting too many advertisements
* Ignoring disclosure requirements
* Depending on one viral video
* Ignoring audience feedback
* Failing to check current monetization rules

Building an audience takes time, and monetization works better when it is connected naturally to the content.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can you make money on TikTok?

Yes. Eligible creators can potentially earn through TikTok's monetization features, while other creators can make money through sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, UGC, and business leads.

How do you make money on TikTok?

You can explore creator monetization programs, brand partnerships, affiliate marketing, product sales, digital products, services, LIVE features, UGC, and business promotion.

Can you make money on TikTok without followers?

You can start building income opportunities without a massive following. Services, UGC, products, and affiliate marketing can work with smaller but relevant audiences.

How do you make money from TikTok videos?

Videos can generate income through eligible creator programs or indirectly through sponsorships, affiliate sales, products, services, and customer leads.

How do I get monetized on TikTok?

Check TikTok Studio for the monetization programs available to your account and review the current eligibility requirements for your region.

Does TikTok pay for views?

Eligible TikTok programs may reward qualifying views according to their rules, but not every view automatically generates money.

What is the TikTok Creator Fund?

The Creator Fund was an earlier TikTok creator monetization program. TikTok has introduced newer monetization options, including the Creator Rewards Program in eligible markets.

Can you make money on TikTok with a small account?

Yes, depending on the monetization method. A small but highly targeted audience can potentially generate income through services, affiliate products, UGC, sponsorships, or your own products.

Final Thoughts

So, **can you make money on TikTok?** Yes, but there isn't one guaranteed method that works for every creator.

You can explore direct TikTok monetization where available, or use TikTok as a way to build an audience for sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, UGC, and other business opportunities.

If you're just starting, focus on creating original content around one clear topic. Learn what your audience responds to, build trust, and then introduce a monetization method that naturally fits your content.

The goal isn't simply to get more views. It's to build an audience that has a reason to keep watching, following, and eventually supporting what you offer.

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